

# The telephone

Long before the telephone was invented, people knew that sound could travel along a wire—children could do it with two tin cans and some string. In the second half of the 20th century, many individuals searched for a better way to transmit speech. The Scotsman Alexander Bell made a breakthrough in 1876 by converting sound into an electric current that could be sent along wires.



ALEXANDER GRAHAM BELL

In 1876, scientist Alexander Graham Bell, working on the invention of the telephone in the US, became the first person to receive a patent for it. An astute business sense and flair for promotion kept him ahead of his rivals.

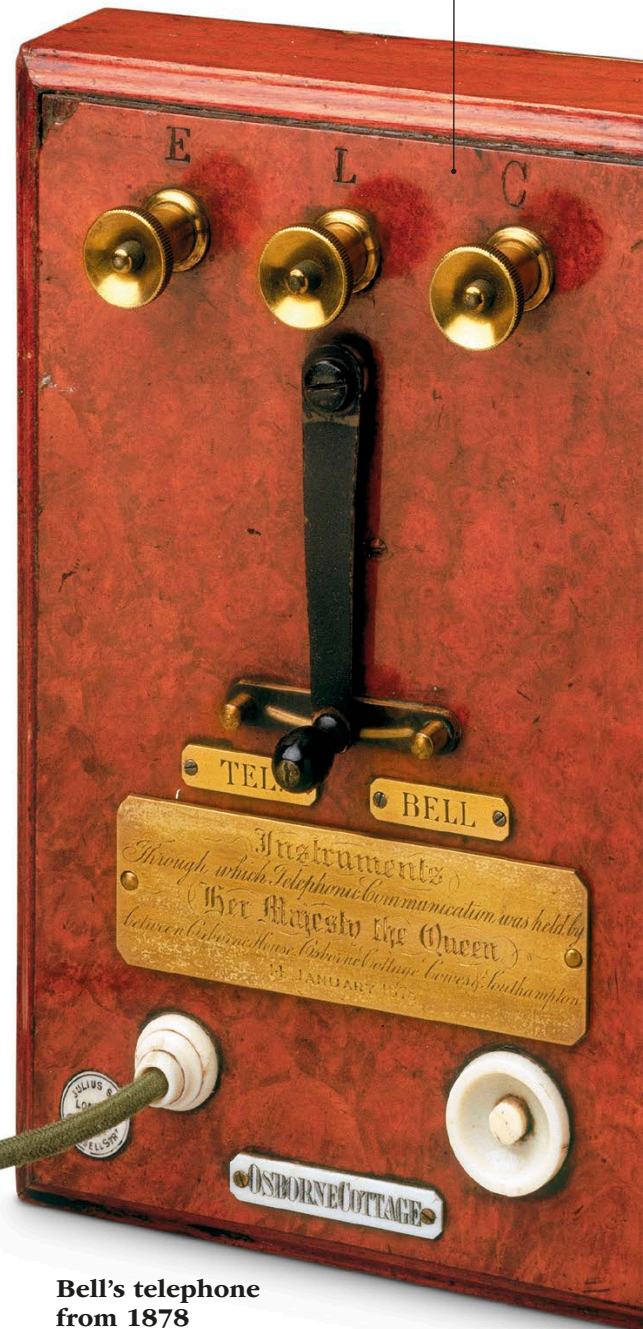
## FIT FOR A QUEEN

In 1878, in the UK, Queen Victoria was given a demonstration of the telephone by Bell on the Isle of Wight. Bell called Southampton and London in the UK. The queen liked the telephone so much that she wanted to buy it.



The receiver is then held to the ear to hear the reply.

Bell's telephone was given a beautiful wooden case for the royal demonstration.



Bell's telephone from 1878